DESTINY DISCOVERED

In the quest to make life mean something more than three meals a day, a comfortable bed at night and an existence that is neither too burdensome nor too boring, I have come to the realization that life has to have at least three things:

1. A sense of purpose
2. An opportunity to contribute
3. A developing legacy

Until the age of twenty six, I really had nothing more than a few selfish hopes surrounded by indulgences and fantasy. My thinking was shallow and fleeting, with a limited attention span that related only to what gave me either satisfaction or reward.

To many people an illusion of security and a sense of belonging or acceptance seem to be sufficient. They measure life by familiar events such as holidays, birthdays, salary rises and promotions, or by their possessions or the happy and unhappy events that come and go in the parade of life.

For me that was not enough. It seemed so superfluous, so repetitive and so out of control; in effect, it would say little more that that I had arrived on this planet, stayed for a while and then departed.

Surely we human beings are more than just another species of the animal kingdom. Our ability to think, imagine and reason must set us apart. And what of the history of the human race, with its kings and kingdoms, inventions and exploration, wars, music, art, structures and literature? Is it all meaningless?

How is it that some people serve and others rule? Some create and build, while others stagnate or seek to destroy. Does a human being, who is not consulted about being born, have a meaning, a contribution to make or a legacy to be realized?

For most people these and many other similar questions seem to be nor more than occasional, involuntary, fleeting thoughts of little or no consequence; and yet deep in the human consciousness man has a desperate desire to participate in a more complete and satisfying life.

The beginnings of this tutorial program may seem to be elementary, but as we progress you will be drawn like a magnet to a sense of belonging as you participate in what could be the most important studies of your life.

As a young man of twenty six, I experienced a dramatic change in my life that made me realize that, if I were to be complete, fulfilled and productive as a person, I must expand the boundaries of my imagination and thoughts within the confines of specific, predetermined limitations.

One of the tasks I set myself was to come to grips with this question:

What make people different? Why are some leaders and some followers?

Why is it that some people create great literature and music that stands the test of time, while others seems to work just as hard but to no avail? Is it possible to observe the difference or is the difference between the mediocre and the great so mystical that it cannot be observed with natural senses? What is it that separates those who are the history-makers from those who are the maintenance or supportive participants in such events? Could it be that nothing is separate and that each person becomes part of a gigantic web? If so, how does the pattern evolve? Who or what is the instigator? In other words, what make the great, great?

At first, I thought the chances of finding such an awesome answer were quite remote. If it were possible to know, then surely the answer would have been discovered long ago and would by now be part and parcel of everyday learning and experience!

My plan became very simple. I would make an in-depth study of people who had made a significant contribution, impression or change in any area of life. I would study the information available to try to determine their likes and dislikes, their childhood experiences, the influences on their lives, the climate of the times in which they lived, anything unusual or even anything "usual", whether a single occurrence or a repeated event, that proved to be significant in their lives.

The words of Shakespeare's Malvolio appeared too simplistic when he said, "some are born great, some achieve greatness and some have greatness thrust upon them." It left too many questions unanswered, because it gave no hope for average people who are neither born into greatness nor have greatness thrust upon them. It meant, in essence, that the majority of the human race have no say in the matter and are merely pawns in the cruel game called life, moved or set down by some sadistic player.

My quest was to obtain some firm answers that could not only be believed idealistically but could stand the scrutiny of life in the real world where men and women have to live, and sometimes die, by what they believe to be true. To find out what makes the great, great became imperative. I had to have an answer and I was prepared to accept the discipline, pain and endurance necessary to discover what it was.

The only way to eavesdrop on history and the personal events of the famous and infamous was by reading books. As I was poor, I sought out bargains on the special counters of bookshops; whenever I could I purchased biographies that seemed interesting. Occasionally I found a gem, such as Dale Carnegie's biographical roundup with its condensed life stories and important facts. I would not borrow books (and still will not today) because I believed that purchasing a book, whatever the cost, always indicated a measure of commitment that added to the reality of what I was doing and, in a sense, made it my own personal adventure.

Year after year I persisted and today, after thirty years of investigation, discovery, reading and studying more than sixteen hundred biographies and other relevant material I can speak with certainty and conviction on *that which makes the great, great.*

Read for yourself the life of Sir Winston Churchill. On the eve of being appointed Prime Minister of Great Britain, he turned to his wife and said, "I have no need of dreams tonight. The facts are more important than dreams. Clemy, I believe I was born for this hour". Of course, it was the great Sir Winston Churchill who galvanized his country, and later the rest of the world, to fight and win a war against tyranny and oppression. When you observe his life you must ask the question, *What makes the great, great?*

Mahatma Gandhi was so committed to his task of shaking off the chain of colonial rule that it was said about him, "Beware of this man; he has no use for adulation, power, money, sex or fame. He is without a doubt the most dangerous of all men because he holds nothing that he fears to lose, not even his own life". It was Mahatma Gandhi who was victorious through what he called "Satyagraha", or "soul force", without violence. Others have sought to copy him and have failed miserably. So the question is still asked, even with the wisdom and knowledge of hindsight: *What made Mahatmas Gandhi great?*

As I continued to read, observe and study the lives of great people down through the centuries, like Genghis Khan, Joan of Arc, Napoleon, Pasteur, Galileo, Madame Curie, and something about our more modern heroes like Lawrence of Arabia, Wilbur and Orville Wright, Dr. Martin Luther King, Dr Billy Graham, General Douglas MacArthur, General George Patton, Ray Crock, W. Clement Stone, Dr. Norman Vincent Peale and many, many others, there seemed to be an invisible thread that magically held them together, and yet separated them from the rest of humanity. Yet it was illusive enough to be lost or to hide between the cracks of their everyday lives. What was it? Where could I find it? How could I obtain it?

I read the books, studied the lives, and identified their similarities. I had been involved in leadership around the world myself. But the answer continued to tantalize and frustrate me until one day, as I read my Bible, I came again upon the story of Jesus Christ.

He was predestined to die and, knowing fully the implications of that forthcoming event, He set his face as flint towards Jerusalem.

Eureka! Eureka! I had found it! I had found that for which I had searched so long. And that was not all, because I realized that during the search, I had changed. The truth of the answer became so abundantly clear to me I wondered why I had not observed it before.

What makes the great, great is a *sense of destiny.*

Hence the name of this program: *Destiny.* As you study the manuals, use the work books, watch the videos, and listen to the cassette tapes, I will guide you as your personal tutor through the steps of creating, through three in-depth applications to your own life, a

process that will open the doors of opportunity for you to develop your own personal sense of *Destiny.*

This advanced tutorial is a new and exciting method created to stimulate you towards dynamic achievement, enabling you to discover and fulfill the destiny of your life at the highest possible level. A great deal will depend upon your honest approach to the questions, illustrations and principles and your commitment to the total program, together with the wise use of questionnaires and follow-up, by returning the pro forma goal sheets and mission statements for assessment.

The completion of this experience of destiny will remove fuzzy thinking, give confidence about your future and your abilities, and in many instances, expand the boundaries of your imagination and thought beyond that which is normally expected.

Destiny will also remove fear and timidity by providing a positive perception of life. You can trust the principles portrayed in the lessons that follow because they have been and continue to be tested and tried in almost all areas of life around the world with success and, at times, with outstanding accomplishment.

You are about to go on an adventure that can only be undertaken by you, because you are unique in character, mental make-up and spiritual capacity. The growth in your life cannot, and must not, be restricted and your contribution to the rest of humanity is your gift to those of us who are here to observe and enjoy it and to the generations that follow. In the giving, your own destiny will be forged.

LESSON 1

DESTINY SUPPORT SYSTEM

As I studied the lives of those who were great, it seemed as if they each had a special set of personal rules that governed their very existence. These rules were rarely changed over a lifetime, unless they were found to be inadequate, unworkable or false. Almost every decision, whether by impulse or continual reflective thought, was reassessed against some inward criteria that for them was the very essence of who they really were and what they stood for. Leaders, champions, and even the despots had a code and, as we observe them against the backdrop of history (and some are found morally wanting), their code was to prove to be their trademark and, in some cases, the foundation for their magnificence or their ultimate undoing.

To some their code or belief system meant more than life itself and rather than conform or abandon it, they chose death, as they could not bear or even imagine life without it while still being true to their inner self.

A critical and thorough examination of our philosophy of life would provide some interesting answers in respect to our stability and success quotient. I found that the people who stood steadfast and strong against the conflicts and contradictions of life always seemed to respond in a way that appeared to make them assured and secure. They even benefited from what others saw as a threat to the status quo or an uncertainty about the future.

The greats always responded, sometimes almost instinctively but always positively, according to what they believed their role was in the scheme of things. I observed that a philosophy of life that acts as a foundation for the ups and downs of life's pilgrimage provides the first key to greatness because, by its very nature, it creates a balance and a sense of guidance in respect to our true self, and just how far we will venture towards any crisis, opportunity or predetermined goal.

Most people wonder why they never fulfill a task or succeed with a project. Rather than look at their philosophy, they look back to external dynamics such as circumstances, timing and personalities which, in many cases, have very little to do with the real outcome and often only provide an excuse for failure.

So let's relate all of this to your life and see if we can discover what you philosophy is. Let's probe and measure it against reality and see if you are prepared to fulfill the first great step in your own personal destiny by creating your own philosophy of life.

Answer the following questions, circling or ticking the appropriate answer when required.

1. Other than those you love and your own health or well-being, what is the most important ingredient in your life? Be precise.

_____

_____

_____

_____

2. What characteristic do you admire most in others that you would like to have yourself?

_____

_____

_____

_____

3. If you could change any three things in your behaviour, what would they be?

1. _____

2. _____

3. _____

4. What influences in your life do you feel are out of your control?

1. _____

2. _____

3. _____

5. What influences in your life do you feel are under your control?

1. _____

2. _____

3. _____

6. What do you believe to be the three most driving and controlling influences that determine the continuation of the universe?

1. _____

2. _____

3. _____

7. Name three limiting factors in your life.

1. _____

2. _____

3. _____

8. Rate in order of importance – body, mind and spirit.

1. _____

2. _____

3. _____

9. Do you believe that you have a bad, good or excellent opportunity to develop a meaningful contribution to the world?

☐ 1. Bad
☐ 2. Good
☐ 3. Excellent

10. If you were to give someone else advice about being successful, what are the three most important things you would tell them?

1. _____

2. _____

3. _____

11. Name three things you would like your life to stand for?

1. _____

2. _____

3. _____

12. Name three things that you would not be prepared to do.

1. _____

2. _____

3. _____

13. How do you feel those who know you best would rate your future possibility?

- ☐ 1. Outstanding
- ☐ 2. Average
- ☐ 3. Poor

14. Is money or material wealth important to you?

- ☐ 1. Yes
- ☐ 2. No
- ☐ 3. Take it or leave it

15. Give six measurable ways in which you could get things done to change the world without your or anyone else' money.

1. _____

2. _____

3. _____

4. _____

5. _____

6. _____

16. Give six measurable ways in which you can get things done to change the world with money.

1. _____

2. _____

3. _____

4. _____

5. _____

6. _____

17. Do you feel any obligation to do any of the points listed in 15 and 16? Please name them

1. _____

2. _____

3. _____

4. _____

5. _____

6. _____

18. Of the schemes and dreams you have had, how would you rate their success possibilities (not how they turned out, but how they could have been)?

☐ 1. Good
☐ 2. Fair
☐ 3. Bad

19. Do you have any limitations or preferences in respect to your acceptance of people of another culture, race, religion or behaviour patterns (give reasons)?

☐ Yes ☐ No

Culture _____

Race _____

Religion _____

20. List six absolutes that govern your thoughts and actions.

1. _____
2. _____
3. _____
4. _____
5. _____
6. _____

21. How do you justify your absolutes?

1. _____
2. _____
3. _____
4. _____
5. _____
6. _____

22. If you believe in a God or a Superior Being, answer the following:

Why _____

_____

_____

Advantages _____

_____

_____

Disadvantages _____

_____

_____

Evidence of existence _____

_____

_____

23. If you don't believe in a God or Superior Being, answer the following:

Why _____

_____

_____

Advantages _____

_____

_____

Disadvantages _____

_____

_____

Evidence of existence _____

24. a) How do you rate the times that you live in as far as your opportunity for success is concerned?

- ☐ Excellent
- ☐ Good
- ☐ Fair
- ☐ Bad

Give three reasons for your selection

1. _____

2. _____

3. _____

b) Are other people, by their performance, proving you right / wrong? Give a simple explanation why you think it is so.

_____

_____

_____

25. Do you think that most successful people became that way because of (tick the appropriate boxes):

a) Inherited wealth ☐
b) A uniquely gifted min ☐
c) Unusual opportunities ☐
d) Special assistance ☐
e) Personal development ☐
f) Hard work ☐
g) A lucky break ☐
h) Strong principles ☐
i) A good plan ☐
j) A good idea ☐

Other factors:

k) _____

l) _____

m) _____

n) _____

o) _____

p) _____

q) _____

26. If you could choose three people to assist you in your life's adventure, whom would you choose and for what reasons?

1. _____

Reason: _____

_____

2. _____

Reason: _____

_____

3. _____

Reason: _____

_____

27. If someone lets you down in a personal relationship, what responsibility do you have to meet your obligations?

- ☐ None
- ☐ Some
- ☐ Total
- ☐ Other

Why? _____

_____

_____

_____

28. In a business relationship, if the other party does not fulfill their agreement, what is your obligation?

- ☐ None
- ☐ Some
- ☐ Total
- ☐ Other

Why? _____

_____

_____

_____

29. Do you believe you have any obligation to assist those people who are truly disadvantaged?

☐ Yes ☐ No

If the answer is no, then say why. If the answer is yes, say how.

_____

_____

_____

_____

30. What percentage would each of the factors below represent out of the total figure of 100, towards success for a person or project?

*	Personal influence	_____
**	The influence of others	_____
***	Economic and social influences	_____
****	Uncontrollable influences	_____
		100 %

If you acknowledge that all successful people have a foundation of belief which acts as a stabilizer and a strengthener, enabling them to act and react with confidence and advantage towards the challenges of life, the previous 30 questions would have assisted you to crystallize your thoughts and to create a firm belief system for your own life. But until you believe it and put it into written form, then it will still remain a theory rather than a strong belief support system.

The following list will give you some suggested principles that you may wish to use as a basis for your philosophy. Assessing these principles will give a deeper meaning to your commitment to a successful life.

I believe a philosophy of life should contain at least the following for us to function as successful human beings. We need a set of proven principles and rules to live or die by that will be long term and provide

_____ clear thinking during times of confusion
_____ confidence in times of doubt
_____ appreciation in times of satisfaction
_____ peace in times of trouble
_____ courage in times of threat
_____ faith to face the unknown
_____ adaptability and resolve to handle disasters.

Our moral code must help us to respect and add dignity to all humanity and encourage self-help at all levels of society, but provide special assistance to the truly disadvantaged. This philosophy of life will put into true perspective, for all times, our commitment and behaviour in all areas of life.

Write out a concise description of your Destiny Support System from the answers you gave to the 30 questions on one sheet. This description should not consist of your answers to those questions, which are for your own records. It should rather be a positive statement of your philosophy of life, which is based on those answers and give particular attention to your personal goals – what you wish to head towards and what you want to leave behind. This statement should be a long-term affirmation for your daily use in the years to come.